The six-month transition plan, dated from your certificate

Your deadline is not September 2029. Your certification body transitions you at your recertification audit, two to three months before your certificate expires. Find that date, count back six months, and this is the work in order. Written from the auditor's side of the table by Ryan Bence, ISO 9001 Lead Auditor. Clause numbers are pointers to your licensed copy; nothing here reproduces the standard.

> **Find your date.** Certificate expiry, minus two to three months, is your recertification audit. If it falls before September 2029, that audit is your transition audit. Subtract six more months: that is when the gap analysis, the document sweep and the first management review under the 2026 inputs must be done.

WHEN THE WORK IS DUE

Your recert audit	Your transition audit	Gap analysis done by	Internal audit to 2026 by
Early 2027	Early 2027 (at recert)	October 2026	December 2026
Late 2027	Late 2027 (at recert)	March 2027	June 2027
2028	2028 (at recert)	Six months prior	Three months prior
Early to mid 2029	2029 (at recert)	Six months prior	Three months prior
After the window closes	A surveillance or special audit in 2028 to 2029; confirm with your CB	Early 2028	Mid 2028

THE SIX MONTHS

Month	Work	Clauses in play
1	Buy the 2026 edition. Score every sub-clause 0 to 3 against it, with the evidence beside each score; weight the rows by what changed (new 3, expanded 2.5, reworded 1.5, unchanged 1). Rank by severity.	All; the clause-by-clause change list
2	Document control sweep. Run the search strings (10.3, Annex B, outputs, 6.1 with no sub-clause, 2015) through every document; fix every clause reference that moved or disappeared. Keep the list of what you fixed.	7.5, 10.1, the 11 search strings
3	Rebuild the management review agenda to the thirteen 2026 inputs, with an owner on each, and hold one so a review is on record under the new edition.	9.3.2, 9.3.3
4	Update the internal audit checklist to the 2026 edition and run an internal audit against it.	9.2.2, plus the new items in 4.1, 5.1.1, 6.3, 7.3, 8.4.3
5	Close the findings. Awareness training on quality culture and ethical behavior, the part an auditor tests by asking a person a question.	7.3, 10.2
6	Transition audit.	

FIVE QUESTIONS TO SEND YOUR CERTIFICATION BODY, IN WRITING

1. On what date will you stop issuing certificates to ISO 9001:2015?
2. Will you transition us at a surveillance audit, or only at recertification?
3. How many additional audit days will the transition add, and at what rate?
4. Will you accept our current management review and internal audit as evidence, or must both be performed against the 2026 edition before the transition audit?
5. What happens to our certificate if the transition audit raises a major nonconformity and the window has closed?

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